Cindervale Alchemist

Player's Handbook

Classes, Prestige Paths, Locations, Factions & Game Systems

Version 6.0 — Settlement & Companion Update

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Chapter 1: Game Overview

Cindervale Alchemist is a fantasy workshop management RPG. You play an alchemist who arrives in a frontier settlement, builds a workshop, and grows a business through brewing potions, enchanting equipment, foraging ingredients, researching recipes, and managing staff.

The Core Loop

Forage ingredients > Brew potions > Sell to customers > Earn gold & XP > Level up > Unlock recipes & features > Upgrade workshop > Build faction reputation > Invest in settlement > Face the Hollow March

The game features 3 locations, 153 recipes, 122 enchantments, 237 ingredients, 6 base classes with 18 specializations, 8 prestige classes, 21 companion creatures, 10 settlement projects, and 11 factions.

Chapter 2: Races

Your race provides a permanent skill bonus that shapes your early game.

Human — +1 persuasion, +1 networking

Versatile and adaptable. Humans thrive in any discipline.

> *"Humans can talk their way into — or out of — just about anything."*

Halfling — +1 haggling

Small but resourceful, with a supernatural knack for commerce.

> *"Something about those big, earnest eyes makes even the most hardened merchant drop their prices."*

Elf — +1 research

Ancient and perceptive, with centuries of accumulated knowledge.

> *"When you've had four hundred years to read, you develop an instinct for where the answers hide."*

Dwarf — +1 precision

Stout and industrious. Master crafters of stone, metal, and reagent.

> *"Dwarven hands were made for delicate work — a paradox their thick fingers seem to defy."*

Goliath — +1 endurance

Towering and tireless. Built like a mountain and twice as stubborn.

> *"Goliaths simply don't tire. Where others flag by afternoon, a Goliath is just getting warmed up."*

Dragonborn — +1 inscription

Draconic heritage carries an innate affinity for runic magic.

> *"The old draconic tongue is the root language of all enchantment runes."*

Chapter 3: Ability Scores & Skills

You have 6 ability scores. During creation, distribute points across them. Modifier = (score - 10) / 2, rounded down.

Ability Scores

Creativity — Governs improvisation and experimental brewing. Key stat for Alchemist.

Intuition — Governs attunement and divination. Key stat for Warden.

Acumen — Governs research, analysis, and inscription. Key stat for Scholar and Enchanter.

Technique — Governs precision and refinement. Key stat for Artificer.

Commerce — Governs persuasion, networking, and haggling. Key stat for Merchant.

Discipline — Governs endurance, focus, and danger sense. Key stat for combat checks.

Skills

Skill Ranks: Untrained (0) > Novice (1) > Adept (2) > Expert (3). Higher ranks multiply your proficiency bonus on checks.

Improvisation (CRE) — Adds to d20 craft roll for CRE-based recipes.

Aesthetics (CRE) — +2g per rank to potion sell and shelf price.

Innovation (CRE) — +6% per rank to Research discovery chance.

Adaptation (CRE) — +rank bonus to craft on recipes brewed fewer than 5 times.

Attunement (INT) — Adds to d20 craft roll for INU-based recipes.

Danger Sense (INT) — Rank x 12% chance to avoid negative expedition events.

Arcane Sensitivity (INT) —

Divination (INT) — Rank x 10% per hour to find +1 bonus ingredient.

Lore (ACU) — +rank x 4 bonus XP on quest turn-ins. At rank 4+, Research costs 1h.

Research (ACU) — Adds to d20 craft roll for ACU-based recipes. +4% per rank to discovery.

Appraisal (ACU) — +rank x 3g on enchanting rewards.

Analysis (ACU) — Rank x 5% chance per craft to auto-succeed.

Precision (TEC) — Adds to d20 craft roll for TEC-based recipes.

Inscription (TEC) — THE enchanting skill — your d20 roll when inscribing.

Extraction (TEC) — THE foraging skill — your d20 roll each expedition hour.

Refinement (TEC) — Rank x 6% chance to produce a bonus extra at no cost.

Haggling (COM) — -rank/2 off buy prices. +rank to sell price.

Persuasion (COM) — All rep gains multiplied by (1 + rank x 6%).

Networking (COM) — Increases morning potion orders and enchantment customers.

Procurement (COM) — Rank x 8% chance per rare ingredient to appear in shop.

Endurance (DIS) — Rank x 10% chance any action costs 0 Energy.

Efficiency (DIS) — -rank hours off expedition travel.

Stockpiling (DIS) — +rank x 2 max shelf. +rank x 3 spoilage threshold.

Focus (DIS) — +rank to Inscription. Rank x 5% for Masterwork enchantments.

Chapter 4: Base Classes & Specializations

There are 6 base classes. Choose one at character creation. Each has 10 levels of features and 3 specialization paths unlocking at class level 3.

Alchemist

Primary Stat: Intuition
Proficiencies: Attunement, Improvisation

Brew potions, the core craft loop

Class Features

Lv	Feature	Description
1	**Potion Crafting**	Begin your alchemical journey. +1 craft bonus and 10% ingredient save chance.
2	**Ingredient Sense**	+1 to all craft checks. +1 extraction bonus from heightened reagent awareness.
3	**Specialization**	Choose a specialization path. +5% ingredient save chance.
4	**Efficient Brewing**	15% chance to save one ingredient per brew.
5	**Double Batch**	25% chance to produce 2× potions on success.
6	**Intuitive DC**	Craft checks can't roll below 5. 10% lucky brew chance for bonus potions.
7	**Master Brewer**	+2 to all craft checks (stacks). Unlock one legendary recipe.
8	**Reagent Attunement**	Foraging may yield bonus ingredients attuned to your most-brewed recipe. +15% ingredient efficiency on all crafts.
9	**Perfected Art**	Craft failures on recipes brewed 10+ times produce a lesser version instead. Once per day, reroll a failed craft.
10	**Magnum Opus**	Your 3 most-brewed recipes auto-succeed at Masterwork quality. Once per day, brew any recipe mastered 20+ times with zero ingredients. Alchemy flows through you like breathing.

Alchemist Specializations (Choose at Class Level 3)

Apothecary

Unique Mechanic: Clinic. Patients arrive daily with ailments that must be diagnosed and treated with the right healing potion. Successful treatments earn XP, gold, and reputation. Higher Apothecary levels improve diagnosis accuracy. At Lv10, you brew one free Healing Salve each morning automatically.

Healers and clinicians. Cure ailments, brew restorative potions, and earn gold treating patients.

Lv	Feature	Description
3	**Healer's Touch**	Healing potions are 2× value/XP. Healing recipes -2 DC.
6	**Panacea**	Unlock multi-cure recipes. Healing potions also restore morale to staff.
10	**Miracle Worker**	Clinic patients auto-diagnosed on arrival. Clinic treatments pay 3× gold and XP. Once per day, perform a Miracle Cure on any patient regardless of potion requirements (5× reward). All healing potions have 50% chance to produce a bonus Masterwork copy.

Transmuter

Unique Mechanic: Transmutation Lab. Convert ingredients between types at a 2:1 ratio (improving to 1:1 at Lv10). Select a source ingredient and target, spending multiples of one to create another. At higher levels you can transmute faction-specific resources and convert potions between types.

Masters of ingredient conversion. Transform materials at ever-better ratios and transmute across types.

Lv	Feature	Description
3	**Efficient Transmutation**	Can convert ingredients at 2:1 ratio. Unlock transmutation recipes.
6	**Lead to Gold**	Transmute faction-specific ingredients. Convert potions between types.
10	**Philosopher's Stone**	1:1 ingredient conversion. Transmutations cost 0 hours.

Venomist

Unique Mechanic: Venom Contracts. Shady clients post poison contracts offering premium gold for specific volatile brews. The Venom Lab on your workshop screen shows available contracts with deadlines and rewards. Craft bonuses scale with level, and failures at Lv10 still produce lesser venoms.

Brew volatile poisons and offensive concoctions. Sell deadly wares to guard factions for premium gold.

Lv	Feature	Description
3	**Volatile Mixtures**	Unlock offensive/volatile recipes. Poisons sell 2× to local guard factions. +2 craft bonus on volatile recipes.
6	**Concentrated Dose**	Brew with deadly precision. +20% double batch chance. +2 craft bonus.

10	**Plague Doctor**	Legendary venom recipes. +3 craft bonus. 30% double batch on volatile brews. Craft failures produce lesser venoms. Venom contracts pay 3× base price. Unlock 2 legendary poisons that reduce specific threat levels by 15 when brewed.

Enchanter

Primary Stat: Creativity
Proficiencies: Inscription, Arcane Sensitivity

Inscribe runes, premium gold from customers

Class Features

Lv	Feature	Description
1	**Inscribe Enchantment**	Can enchant customer items. Gain proficiency in Inscription and Arcane Sensitivity. +1 inscription, material cost -1.
2	**Mana Flow**	+1 to all inscription checks. Enchanting material cost reduced by 1 (min 1).
3	**Specialization**	Choose a specialization path. +5 inscription bonus.
4	**Arcane Mastery**	+8% enchant success chance. See customer satisfaction hints.
5	**Dual Inscription**	Apply 2 enchantments to a single customer item (second at +3 DC).
6	**Resonance**	Enchanting customers pay 25% more gold. Unlock 2 new enchantment patterns.
7	**Overcharge**	Natural 20 inscription = "Masterwork" enchantment worth 3× gold.
8	**Archmage**	DC 12 and below enchantments auto-succeed. +2 inscription (stacks).
9	**Rune Library**	Know all enchantment patterns regardless of faction requirements.
10	**Reality Weaver**	Inscription mastery: +12 flat bonus, +50% gold from enchanting. Crits on 17+.

Enchanter Specializations (Choose at Class Level 3)

Runesmith

Unique Mechanic: Runesmith Forge. A dedicated forging station appears in your workshop where you can craft magical weapons. Each day you get a limited number of forge uses (1 at Lv3, scaling to 3 at Lv10). Forged weapons sell at premium prices and weapon enchantments get bonus value.

Forge powerful weapon enchantments. Martial runes command top prices from warriors and adventurers.

Lv	Feature	Description
3	**Battle Runes**	Weapon/martial enchantments +25% value. -1 DC on weapon runes.
6	**Runic Mastery**	All enchantment material costs -1. Can re-enchant failed items same day.
10	**Legendary Arms**	Artifact-grade weapon enchantments. Martial enchants worth 3× gold.

Wardkeeper

Unique Mechanic: Shield Commissions. Defensive enchantment orders arrive from clients needing warded armor and shields. The commission system tracks your active orders with deadlines. Inscription bonuses stack for defensive work, and at Lv10 permanent wards auto-succeed at DC 15.

Specialize in defensive enchantments. Layer protective wards for lucrative shield commissions.

Lv	Feature	Description
3	**Wards**	Defensive enchantments +50% value. +2 to defensive inscription checks.
6	**Layered Wards**	Can apply 3 enchantments to armor items. 40% chance to save materials on enchant success.
10	**Unbreakable**	Permanent wards that never fade. Defensive enchants auto-succeed DC 15. Shield commissions pay 3× gold. Once per day, apply a Fortress Ward to the settlement — reduces all threats by 5 for 3 days.

Spellweaver

Unique Mechanic: Planar Attunement. Attune to extraplanar power sources that modify your enchantments with exotic effects. The Planar Focus interface lets you select and channel different planar energies. At Lv10, Planar Convergence lets you combine two enchantment types into a single inscription.

Craft exotic utility enchantments and tap into planar power sources. Attract rare, high-paying customers.

Lv	Feature	Description
3	**Exotic Inscriptions**	Utility/exotic enchantments unlocked. +2 to exotic inscription checks.
6	**Planar Weave**	Extraplanar power sources. Exotic enchants worth 2× and attract special customers.
10	**Planar Convergence**	Impossible enchantments. Can combine two enchant types into one inscription.

Artificer

Primary Stat: Technique
Proficiencies: Precision, Refinement

Optimize everything, salvage failures

Class Features

Lv	Feature	Description
1	**Technical Crafting**	+1 to TEC-based craft checks. Gain proficiency in Precision and Refinement.
2	**Salvage**	Recover 50% of ingredients on craft failure (rounded up).
3	**Specialization**	Choose a specialization path. +10% salvage on failures.
4	**Calibration**	-1 DC for recipes you've brewed 3+ times. Auto-succeed DC 8 and below.
5	**Overclock**	Workshop upgrades provide 50% more of their numerical bonuses.
6	**Production Line**	Batch brew: +10% success rate per item after the first.
7	**Prototype**	Once per day, reroll a failed craft. +15% discovery chance from research.
8	**Grand Artificer**	Unlock legendary device recipes. Workshop upgrade costs -25%.
9	**Systematic Mastery**	Batch brew cap +3. All batch brews show individual roll results.
10	**Masterwork Engine**	Two free 0-hour crafting actions per day. Batch size +2. 100% salvage on failures. Workshop upgrades cost -30% and provide double their normal bonuses. Your workshop is a precision engine.

Artificer Specializations (Choose at Class Level 3)

Tinkerer

Unique Mechanic: Gadget Workshop. Craft utility gadgets from blueprints that provide passive bonuses when equipped. Gadgets can be upgraded through marks (Mk I, Mk II, etc.) for stronger effects. The gadget panel shows your active devices and their bonuses to crafting, foraging, and research.

Build utility gadgets and experiment with unconventional techniques. Innovation over brute force.

Lv	Feature	Description
3	**Gadgeteer**	Craft utility gadgets for passive bonuses. +1 craft bonus. +15% experiment discovery. 50% salvage on failures.
6	**Swiss Army**	Gadgets provide multiple benefits. +15% batch brew success. Workshop upgrades cost -15%.
10	**Masterwork Tools**	Legendary utility tools. All craft DCs -2 permanently. 90% salvage on failure. Gadgets can be upgraded indefinitely beyond mark caps (+1 power per extra mark). Equip 2 gadgets simultaneously.

Constructor

Unique Mechanic: Blueprint Drafting. Draft and build custom workshop structures from blueprints. Each blueprint requires a drafting phase (research) followed by a construction phase (staff assignment). Completed blueprints provide unique workshop bonuses not available through normal upgrades.

Master workshop builder. Upgrades cost less, staff work harder, and legendary blueprints reshape production.

Lv	Feature	Description
3	**Workshop Pro**	Workshop upgrades cost 50% less gold. +2 to DIS checks.
6	**Assembly Floor**	Can batch craft 2 different recipes simultaneously. Staff efficiency +20%.
10	**Master Builder**	Unlock 3 legendary blueprints: Alchemical Forge (auto-brews your most profitable recipe each morning), Crystal Greenhouse (produces 1 random rare ingredient daily), Arcane Conduit (+2 Energy per day permanently). All construction completes in half time.

Reclaimer

Unique Mechanic: Salvage System. Failed brews and enchantments return a percentage of ingredients instead of losing everything. The salvage rate increases with level (75% at Lv3, 100% at Lv10). At Lv6 you can deconstruct finished potions back into ingredients. Spoiled ingredients produce Alchemical Residue.

Waste nothing. Salvage failed brews, break down items for materials, and turn spoilage into profit.

Lv	Feature	Description
3	**Zero Waste**	75% salvage on failure. Break down potions. 50% of spoiled ingredients become Alchemical Residue.
6	**Deconstruct**	Break any item into component ingredients. Failed enchants return all materials.

10	**Perfect Reclamation**	One free craft per day (no ingredients consumed). Deconstruction yields 150%.

Scholar

Primary Stat: Acumen
Proficiencies: Research, Lore

Research, discovery, XP acceleration

Class Features

Lv	Feature	Description
1	**Research Study**	Can conduct research studies to discover recipes. Gain proficiency in Research and Lore. +5% discovery chance.
2	**Speed Reader**	One free research study per day (no hour cost). +10% base discovery chance.
3	**Specialization**	Choose a specialization path. +5% discovery chance.
4	**Eureka!**	Experiments: +15% discovery chance. On discovery, show recipe stat/DC info.
5	**Academic Network**	+15% XP from all sources. +1 free research study per day (2 total).
6	**Cross-Reference**	Experiment Bench shows hints based on how close your combination is.
7	**Thesis Defense**	+3 to all ACU-based checks. Research can discover enchantment patterns too. +15% discovery chance. +10% XP.
8	**Grand Theorem**	+25% discovery chance from all sources. See full ingredient tables for explored regions.
9	**Polymath**	Baseline competence in everything. +2 to all craft, inscription, and extraction checks. +10% XP from all sources.
10	**Omniscience**	Know all recipes. Experiment Bench shows exact results. +2 craft bonus from deep knowledge. +30% XP from all sources. Publish theoretical papers for passive gold.

Scholar Specializations (Choose at Class Level 3)

Theorist

Unique Mechanic: Published Papers. Spend research hours writing academic papers that generate passive gold income over time. Papers earn more as they accumulate citations. Peer Review at Lv6 boosts research discovery rates. At Lv10, all research auto-discovers new recipes.

Publish academic papers for passive income and reputation. Research discovers more, faster, and better.

Lv	Feature	Description
3	**Published Research**	2× XP from research and experiments. Can publish papers for passive gold.
6	**Peer Review**	Research studies have +20% discovery chance. Papers earn more over time.
10	**Grand Unified Theory**	Research sessions produce 2 discoveries instead of 1. Papers earn faction reputation for the discovered recipe's faction. After 10 papers: permanent +1 craft. After 25: +2. After 50: +3. Your academic legacy compounds.

Naturalist

Unique Mechanic: Field Journal. Document ecological observations during foraging expeditions. Journal entries accumulate as you explore different regions and discover ingredients. Completed journal sets unlock discovery bonuses and region-specific recipes. Foraging XP scales significantly with level.

Document flora and geology in a Field Journal. Unlock permanent yield bonuses and seasonal mastery.

Lv	Feature	Description
3	**Field Guide**	See full ingredient tables for explored regions. Experiments with foraged ingredients get +15% discovery.
6	**Ecological Insight**	Research discovers region-specific recipes. +20% XP from foraging and experiments.
10	**Nature's Library**	Every expedition yields 1 bonus hidden-area ingredient (even unmapped areas). Seasonal ingredients available in all seasons. Once per day, commune to reveal the highest-yield region. Field Journal entries grant permanent +2 craft bonus for documented ingredients.

Archivist

Unique Mechanic: Lore Fragments. Discover ancient lore fragments during quests and research. Fragments form chains that, when completed, grant permanent passive bonuses. The Lore Archive tracks your collection and shows incomplete chains. Board quests refresh more often and reward bonus reputation.

Pursue lore fragments and quest chains. Board quests refresh faster, and deep knowledge grants permanent stats.

Lv	Feature	Description
3	**Deep Records**	Quest log shows hidden objectives. +30% quest XP.
6	**Master Index**	Board quests refresh twice daily. Quest chains unlock earlier.

10	**Living Archive**	Completed lore chains grant permanent +1 to a stat of your choice (up to 3 total). Quest turn-ins have 25% chance to also reward a lore fragment. Board quests refresh 3× daily with at least one rare-ingredient quest. Faction alignment bonuses are 50% stronger.

Merchant

Primary Stat: Commerce
Proficiencies: Haggling, Networking

Gold generation, staff, shop mastery

Class Features

Lv	Feature	Description
1	**Shopkeeping**	Enhanced shop front. Shelf sale chance +10%. Gain proficiency in Haggling and Networking.
2	**Bargain Hunter**	Shop buy prices -15%. Sell prices +10%.
3	**Specialization**	Choose a specialization path. +5% sell bonus.
4	**Staff Manager**	+1 max apprentice slot. Staff gain +10% efficiency.
5	**Trade Routes**	Passive income doubled. Shop restocks 2 additional rare items daily. +25% shelf capacity.
6	**Reputation Precedes You**	All faction reputation gains +25%. Faction vendors offer 10% discount.
7	**Golden Tongue**	Enchanting/potion customers pay 20% more. +1 customer per morning.
8	**Trade Empire**	Staff efficiency +30% (stacks). +1 max apprentice. Payroll -25%.
9	**Connections**	Commission 1 specific rare ingredient per day at 3× price (guaranteed).
10	**Trade Empire**	Staff perform 2 tasks simultaneously. All customers pay double. +2 premium customers each morning at 3× price. Once per day, conjure any ingredient into your shop at standard price — your network reaches everywhere.

Merchant Specializations (Choose at Class Level 3)

Guildmaster

Unique Mechanic: Staff Training. Assign apprentices to focused training sessions that boost their specific stats over multiple days. The training interface lets you pick which stat to develop. Staff gain XP 50% faster, and at higher levels you hire from an expanded pool with better base stats.

Build and manage a large staff. Train apprentices faster, hire from elite pools, and halve payroll costs.

Lv	Feature	Description
3	**Training Program**	Staff gain XP 50% faster. Can assign staff to skill training.
6	**Guild Network**	Hire from expanded pool. Staff have higher base stats.
10	**Grand Guildmaster**	Hire up to 8 staff. Staff salary costs halved. Max-level staff gain a Mastery trait doubling their task efficiency. Once per week, a Legendary Apprentice applies (starts Lv3, 2 positive traits, no negatives).

Diplomat

Unique Mechanic: Faction Harmony. Build diplomatic bridges between faction pairs, creating harmony bonuses that benefit both sides. The harmony system tracks relationships you have brokered. Cross-faction quests become available, and faction rep gains are doubled across the board.

Double faction reputation gains and forge cross-faction alliances. Unlock exclusive vendor stock.

Lv	Feature	Description
3	**Embassy**	Double faction rep gains. Faction NPCs offer unique dialogue and quests.
6	**Trade Agreements**	Exclusive faction vendors with rare stock. Cross-faction quests.
10	**Grand Alliance**	Allied with all factions simultaneously. Faction vendors stock legendary items.

Fence

Unique Mechanic: Black Market. Sell potions through underground channels at 2x price (3x at Lv10), but with a risk of confiscation where you lose both goods and gold. Risk decreases with level until you become Untouchable at Lv10 with zero confiscation chance. Smuggling side-quests also become available.

Sell through black market channels at extreme markups. High reward, with risk of confiscation.

Lv	Feature	Description
3	**Black Market**	Sell potions/enchantments at 2× price with risk of confiscation.
6	**Underground Network**	Special black market customers. Reduced confiscation risk.
10	**Untouchable**	Zero confiscation risk. Black market prices 3×. Smuggling side-quests.

Warden

Primary Stat: Discipline
Proficiencies: Extraction, Endurance

Foraging mastery, energy efficiency, endurance

Class Features

Lv	Feature	Description
1	**Trailblazer**	-1 travel time to all regions (min 0). Gain proficiency in Extraction and Endurance.
2	**Enduring Spirit**	+1 Energy per day. Weather penalties halved.
3	**Specialization**	Choose a specialization path. +1 extraction bonus.
4	**Iron Constitution**	Immune to expedition events that cost time. Power through danger.
5	**Expert Forager**	Critical extraction (nat 20) yields 3× ingredients. Successes yield +1 bonus.
6	**Deep Mapping**	Forage a second region in same expedition at -2 hours.
7	**Wilderness Mastery**	+2 extraction bonus. Positive expedition events 2× more likely. 15% chance of bonus rare find per hour.
8	**Expedition Commander**	Staff foraging yields +40%. Staff gain XP 25% faster.
9	**Indomitable**	+3 extraction bonus. +1 bonus ingredient per successful extraction. Failed extractions still yield 1 common ingredient.
10	**Legend of the Wild**	All travel times become 0. +50% foraging yields. Overnight foraging.

Warden Specializations (Choose at Class Level 3)

Ranger

Unique Mechanic: Wild Companions. Befriend wild creatures during foraging expeditions. Companions perform daily actions: gathering ingredients, earning gold, scouting, greeting customers, guarding, or inspiring research. Loyalty grows over time, unlocking secondary abilities and legendary powers. At Lv10, companions perform all actions twice, gain type-specific legendary abilities, and can be sent on solo expeditions from their card.

Tame wild companions that gather, sell, scout, and fight alongside you. The signature beast-bond spec.

Lv	Feature	Description
3	**Tracker**	Target ingredients without yield penalty. Befriend wild creatures.
6	**Pathfinder**	Discover hidden sub-regions with unique ingredients. Creature bonuses grow.
10	**Apex Predator**	Companions perform all actions twice per day. Your highest-loyalty companion (★5) gains a Legendary ability unique to its role: Foragers find rare ingredients, Merchants attract VIPs, Greeters earn referral gold, Guardians heal staff injuries, Muses grant bonus Energy, Scouts negate all expedition danger. Send any companion on a solo expedition from their card (1/day, 0 Energy).

Quartermaster

Unique Mechanic: Supply Chains. Establish trade partnerships with ingredient suppliers who deliver goods automatically on a schedule. Manage caravan runs to different regions for bulk delivery. Partners level up through completed runs, improving quantity and adding rare ingredients.

Master of logistics. Double storage, reduce spoilage, and squeeze maximum value from every ingredient.

Lv	Feature	Description
3	**Supply Chain**	Workshop storage doubled. Ingredient efficiency +25%. Spoilage threshold +4.
6	**Logistics Master**	Ingredient management mastery. Staff foraging +25%. +25% personal foraging yield. +4 spoilage threshold. Caravan deliveries are always fresh.
10	**War Room**	Fully automated ingredient management. Foraging yield +100%. Spoilage threshold +8.

Sentinel

Unique Mechanic: Night Expeditions. After resting, send your character on a bonus night foraging run with extra gathering hours but increased danger. At Lv6, set traps for guaranteed rare finds. At Lv10, build permanent outposts for daily passive ingredient income and threat suppression.

Night expeditions for bonus foraging after dark. Guard the settlement against rising threats.

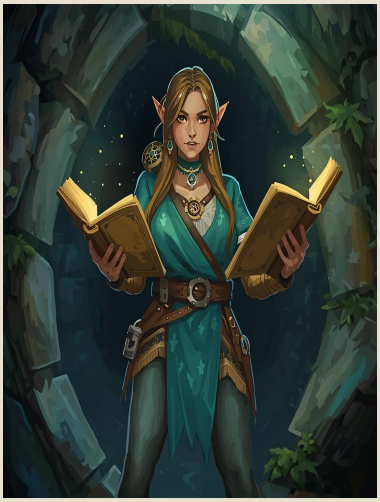
Lv	Feature	Description
3	**Night Watch**	Night expeditions: 2 bonus gathering hours at +4 DC, increased danger.

6	**Trap Setter**	Set traps for guaranteed rare ingredient finds. Night danger reduced.
10	**Eternal Vigil**	Night expeditions reach 4 hours total with reduced DC penalty (+3 instead of +4). Drastically reduced danger. All threats passively decay by 3 per day. Once per day, launch a Preemptive Strike: spend 2 Energy to reduce any threat by 20 and earn XP/gold.

Chapter 5: Prestige Classes

Prestige Unlock: Reach level 3 in two different base classes. Each prestige class has 5 levels.

Cartographer



Requirements: Warden Lv3, Scholar Lv3

Explorer-scholar who maps hidden regions containing unique ingredients.

Prestige Features

Lv	Feature	Description
1	**Hidden Paths**	Discover secret sub-areas within known regions with unique ingredients. 25% chance per forage hour.
2	**Detailed Maps**	Hidden area discovery chance +15%. Mapped areas yield +1 bonus ingredient.
3	**Cartographer's Insight**	See all ingredients in a region before committing to forage. +10% XP from foraging.
4	**Pathfinder's Network**	Staff foraging uses your mapped paths: +25% staff forage yield.
5	**Legendary Atlas**	Discover the Heartforge's hidden chambers. Unique legendary ingredients only you can access.

Spellbrewer

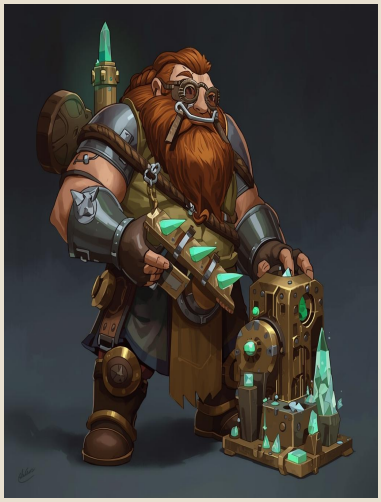
Requirements: Alchemist Lv3, Enchanter Lv3

Creates infused potions that combine brewing and enchanting effects.

Prestige Features

Lv	Feature	Description
1	**Infusion Novice**	Unlock Vigor and Clarity infusions. 2 infusions per day. Catalyst: any ingredient with 5+ stock.
2	**Resonant Brew**	Unlock Fortify infusion. Infusion DC penalty reduced by 1. 3 infusions per day.
3	**Essence Weaver**	Unlock Prosperity infusion. 25% chance catalyst is preserved. 4 infusions per day.
4	**Arcane Distiller**	Unlock Lingering infusion. Catalyst always preserved on Masterwork+ brews. 5 infusions per day.
5	**Grand Spellbrewer**	Stack two infusions on one brew (double catalyst). Infused shelf potions attract +1 daily customer.

Magitech Engineer



Requirements: Artificer Lv3, Enchanter Lv3

Builds magical automata that perform workshop tasks autonomously.

Prestige Features

Lv	Feature	Description
1	**Automaton Frame**	Build a basic automaton (1 active). Performs one task per day at 60% efficiency.
2	**Improved Servos**	Automaton efficiency +20%. Can assign to brew, forage, or shopkeep.
3	**Second Automaton**	+1 automaton slot (2 total). Automata gain XP and level up like staff.
4	**Enchanted Core**	Automata can perform enchanting tasks. Efficiency +20% (total 100%).
5	**Master Construct**	+1 automaton (3 total). Automata can perform prestige tasks. Self-repairing.

Brand Master

Requirements: Merchant Lv3, Alchemist Lv3

Creates named product lines that build customer loyalty and premium pricing.

Prestige Features

Lv	Feature	Description
1	**First Label**	Create 1 brand with up to 2 recipes. Branded potions +10% sell. Brand levels up with sales.
2	**Brand Recognition**	Brands hold 3 recipes. +5 aligned faction rep per 10 branded sales. Sales tracker UI.
3	**Product Line**	2nd brand slot. Brand orders appear (2× price). Branded shelf potions +10% sell chance.
4	**Premium Label**	Brands hold 4 recipes. Famous tier unlocks (+60% sell). Branded MW+ potions extra +25%.
5	**Legendary Brand**	3rd brand slot. Famous brands attract collectors trading rare ingredients. 25% brand rep carries through torch.

Wildcrafter

Requirements: Warden Lv3, Alchemist Lv3

Brews potions in the field using fresh ingredients for bonus potency.

Prestige Features

Lv	Feature	Description
1	**Field Alchemy**	1 field brew per expedition from your haul. Fresh potions sell at 1.2×. Standard quality only.
2	**Fresh Reagents**	2 field brews. Fresh 1.3×. Fine quality field brewing. +1 bonus ingredient per expedition.
3	**Wilderness Recipes**	3 field brews. Fresh 1.4×. Unlock 3 field-only recipes (Vitality Draught, Trailblazer Tonic, Wilderness Elixir).
4	**Master Fieldcrafter**	3 field brews. Fresh 1.5×. Masterwork field brewing. 15% double batch chance.
5	**Living Apothecary**	4 field brews. Auto-suggests best potion. Legendary field-only recipe: Essence of the Wild.

Antiquarian

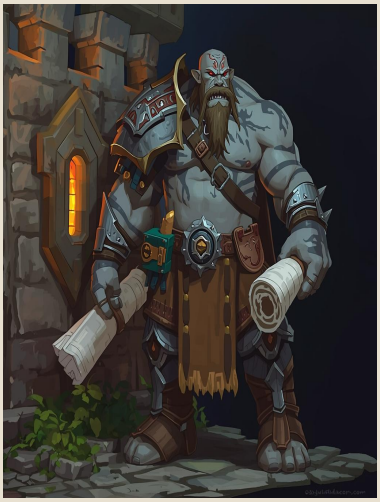
Requirements: Scholar Lv3, Merchant Lv3

Discovers and appraises mysterious relics for massive profit or permanent bonuses.

Prestige Features

Lv	Feature	Description
1	**Relic Sense**	15% relic find chance per expedition hour. Appraise interface unlocked (1 Energy, Acumen check).
2	**Keen Appraisal**	25% find chance. +3 appraisal bonus. See relic rarity before appraising.
3	**Collector's Network**	Sell appraised relics at 3× value. Museum display unlocked. Collection set bonuses active.
4	**Relic Expertise**	35% find chance. Auto-identify (no check). Staff can do Relic Hunt tasks.
5	**Grand Collection**	Complete all 5 sets for +10g/morning museum income. Legendary relics in diff 4+. Set bonuses doubled.

Siege Engineer



Requirements: Warden Lv3, Artificer Lv3

Builds outposts that gather ingredients and suppress external threats.

Prestige Features

Lv	Feature	Description
1	**Field Outpost**	1 outpost slot. Gathers 2 ingredients/morning. Suppresses nearby threats (-3/day).
2	**Fortified Outpost**	2 slots. Gathering +1 (3/morning). -4 suppression. +1 forage yield at outpost regions.
3	**Processing Station**	3 slots. Assign 1 auto-brew recipe per outpost from stored ingredients.
4	**Supply Depot**	3 slots. Gathering +1 (4/morning). -5 suppression. Auto-brewed potions stock to shelves.
5	**Fortress Network**	4 slots. Upgrade one outpost to a fortress (caps one threat at 50). Outposts share storage.

Arcanist

Requirements: Scholar Lv3, Enchanter Lv3

Researches and designs entirely new custom enchantment patterns.

Prestige Features

Lv	Feature	Description
1	**Pattern Research**	Spend 2h to research a new enchantment pattern. Choose effect type and power level.
2	**Refined Patterns**	Custom enchantments get +2 inscription bonus. Can name your creations.
3	**Dual-Effect Patterns**	Design enchantments with two effects. Custom patterns sell at 2× value.
4	**Pattern Library**	Store up to 10 custom patterns. Share patterns with staff for automated inscribing.
5	**Grand Theorem**	Design legendary enchantments. Custom patterns can have 3 effects. Named masterworks.

Chapter 6: Feats

Feats are permanent abilities chosen at even character levels (2, 4, 6, 8, 10, 12, 14, 16).

Crafting Feats

Feat	Description
Careful Hands	Once per day, reroll a failed craft check.
Bulk Processor	Max batch brew size +2.
Recipe Intuition	+10% experiment discovery chance. Experiments cost 0 hours on failure.
Quality Assurance	Brewed potions worth +20% when sold or shelved.
Rapid Infusion	The first brew each day costs 0 hours.
Lucky Brew	10% chance any craft produces a random bonus potion alongside.
Methodical Brewer	Recipes brewed 10+ times get -2 DC permanently. Mastery discount cap +2.

Foraging Feats

Feat	Description
Trailblazer's Boots	-1 travel time to all regions. +1 bonus ingredient per foraging hour.
Lucky Find	10% chance per hour to find a random rare ingredient from any unlocked region.
Companion Handler	Companion actions +50% effectiveness. Companions gain loyalty 2× faster. +15% companion encounter chance.
Seasoned Explorer	+2 to all extraction checks.
Pack Mule	+25% ingredient yield from foraging. +4 spoilage threshold.
Danger Magnet	Events 2× more likely, positive events 3× more likely. High risk, high reward.

Enchanting Feats

Feat	Description
Runelord	+2 to all inscription checks.
Mana Efficient	25% chance to save all enchanting materials on success.
Arcane Recycler	Failed enchants return 75% of ingredients. Successful enchants have 15% chance to produce a bonus scroll.
Runic Savant	+5 flat inscription bonus. +1 inscription. On selection, learn 3 undiscovered enchantment patterns.
Masterwork Focus	Natural 18-20 on inscription = critical (3× reward).

Commerce Feats

Feat	Description
Silver Tongue	+15% shelf sale chance. +10% all sell prices.
Talent Scout	+2 hire candidates. All candidates have +2 to highest stat.
Patron of the Arts	Customer orders pay 25% more. +1 customer per morning.

Supply Lines	Procurement finds 2× rare items. Shop buy prices -10%. +2 max shelf capacity.
Penny Pincher	All gold costs (purchases, upgrades, hiring, payroll) -15%.
Taskmaster	Staff brew/forage efficiency +25%. Staff injuries heal 1 day faster. Weekly free staff reassignment.

General Feats

Feat	Description
Early Riser	First 1-Energy action each day costs 0 Energy.
Multitasker	One free 0-hour action per day.
Jack of All Trades	+1 to all skill checks where you have 0 invested ranks. +1 to your lowest ability score modifier.
Prodigy	+1 to two ability scores of your choice (selected on pick, can exceed soft cap). +5% XP.
Tough	Once per day, reroll a failed check. Negative town events halved.
Focused Mind	+1 skill point every other level (retroactive). +5% XP from all sources.
Lorekeeper	+25% XP from quests/board requests. Quest completion +5 faction rep.
Relentless	After a failed check, +2 to next check of same type. Stacks to +6.
Crisis Responder	During the Hollow March, crisis checks get +3. Brew/enchant solutions need 1 fewer item. Gold solutions cost 20% less.
Ancestral Wisdom	Pass the Torch carries 25% gold (up from 15%), 5 recipes (up from 3), 50% rep (up from 33%). Apprentice starts with +1 Energy.
Fortified Workshop	Threats grow 20% slower. Warning 2 days before 75+ threat events. Workshop upgrades can't be disabled by March failures.

Chapter 7: Locations & Regions

Cindervale

A quiet mountain village built atop the ancient Heartforge.

Region	Difficulty	Unlock	Ingredients
Ashfields	*	Lv 0	11
Ironwood	**	Lv 1	13
Fungal Caves	**	Lv 2	10
Crystal Hollows	***	Lv 3	10
Moonlit Glade	***	Lv 4	12
Volcanic Vents	****	Lv 5	9
Deep Mines	****	Lv 6	13
Heartforge Rim	*****	Lv 8	12

Ashfall Crossing

A bustling desert trading post at the crossroads of three caravan routes.

Region	Difficulty	Unlock	Ingredients
Sunscorch Flats	*	Lv 0	12
Salt Caverns	**	Lv 1	11
Obsidian Wastes	**	Lv 2	12
Sandworm Tunnels	***	Lv 3	11
Oasis Grove	***	Lv 4	11
Molten Vents	****	Lv 5	12
Mirage Bazaar	****	Lv 6	10
Buried Temple	*****	Lv 8	11

Tidecrest Harbor

A weathered port town built into sea cliffs. Coral reefs, sunken ships, and an ancient drowned temple.

Region	Difficulty	Unlock	Ingredients
Driftwood Shores	*	Lv 0	10
Tidal Pools	**	Lv 1	10
Kelp Forest	**	Lv 2	10

Fog Hollows	***	Lv 3	10
Coral Labyrinth	***	Lv 4	10
Shipwreck Graveyard	****	Lv 5	11
Abyssal Trench	****	Lv 6	10
Drowned Sanctum	*****	Lv 8	11

Chapter 8: Factions & Alignment

Each location has friendly factions. Build reputation through quests. Align at Revered for powerful bonuses.

Cindervale Factions

Ashwardens —

Hearthkeepers —

Veilwalkers —

Cinderfolk —

Ashfall Crossing Factions

Sand Merchants Guild —

Flamekeepers —

Dustwalkers —

Tidecrest Harbor Factions

Harbormaster's Guild —

Pearl Divers —

Tidekeepers —

Merchant Marine —

Chapter 9: Companion Creatures

The Ranger class unlocks companion creatures. There are **21 companions** across all three locations. At Ranger Lv10 (Apex Predator), companions perform all actions twice, your highest-loyalty companion gains a type-specific Legendary ability, and you can send any companion on a solo expedition from their card (1/day, 0 Energy).

Chapter 10: Settlement Investment

Starting at level 4, invest gold and materials to build 10 permanent settlement projects in 5 tiers. Staff (up to 3) speed construction. Available projects always visible for ingredient planning.

Tier 1

Project	Cost	Days	Effect	Requires
Paved Roads	300g	3	-1 travel time to all regions	--
Market Square	500g	5	+2 customers/morning, +10% shelf sale, weekly Traveling Merchant	--
Watchtower	400g	4	Threats grow 15% slower, warning at 60+	--

Tier 2

Project	Cost	Days	Effect	Requires
Herbalist Garden	600g	5	2 random ingredients/morning, +1 spoilage threshold	--
Guild Hall	800g	6	+1 staff slot, +2 hire candidates, training costs halved	--

Tier 3

Project	Cost	Days	Effect	Requires
Trade Depot	1000g	7	Contract costs -40%, shop prices -15%, +1 customer/morning	Market Square
Academy	1200g	8	+10% XP permanently, research -1 hour, staff specialization	--

Tier 4

Project	Cost	Days	Effect	Requires
Fortified Walls	1500g	10	Threats capped at 80, events halved, +50g/morning	Watchtower
Grand Library	2000g	12	+25% discovery, +15% lore drops, 2× paper gold	Academy

Tier 5

Project	Cost	Days	Effect	Requires
Monument	3000g	15	+1 all stats, +1 all skills, +5 rep/day to all factions. Carries through Torch.	Fortified Walls

Chapter 11: Core Game Systems

Brewing
Combine ingredients to brew potions. Roll skill + modifier vs DC. Quality tiers sell for more. Mastery reduces DC.

Enchanting
Inscribe magical properties using Inscription skill. 55+ local substitution pairs.

Foraging
Expeditions cost Energy and time. Roll Extraction vs DC each hour.

Research
Spend 2 hours to discover recipes/enchantments. Academy reduces cost by 1 hour.

Staff
Hire apprentices for brewing, foraging, shopkeeping, researching, constructing, or patrolling.

Ingredient Contracts
3 tiers at Market. Daily deliveries for ongoing gold cost. Trade Depot -40%.

Town Events
Random morning events. Negative events blocked 50% by Fortified Walls or companion Guard.

Threats
Three rival factions per location (0-100). Watchtower -15% growth. Walls cap at 80.

Chapter 12: The Hollow March

Endgame invasion at display level 11. Waves of crises every 3-7 days. The Final Stand is a climactic 6-crisis gauntlet at elevated DCs — you choose your approach for each crisis and can freely brew, forage, and prepare between them.

Milestones

- **5 Waves:** Pass the Torch unlocked.
- **10 Waves:** Final Stand available — 6 crises, need 4/6. Resolve at your own pace.
- **Every 3rd Wave:** March-exclusive recipe.

Chapter 13: Pass the Torch & Legacy

After 5 March waves, retire and start a new generation with accumulated bonuses.

What Carries Over

Element	Amount
Gold	15% (cap 150g)
Recipes	Top 3 most-brewed
Faction Rep	1/3 of all
Legacy Feature	Selected chain, permanent
Settlement	All projects persist

Build your workshop. Master your craft. Shape the world.

Cindervale Alchemist v6.0 — Settlement & Companion Update